

SENATE BILL 1306

By Johnson

AN ACT to amend Tennessee Code Annotated, Title 4,
Chapter 3, Part 22, relative to tourism.

BE IT ENACTED BY THE GENERAL ASSEMBLY OF THE STATE OF TENNESSEE:

SECTION 1. Tennessee Code Annotated, Section 4-3-2204(a)(1)(A), is amended by deleting the subdivision and substituting:

There is created in the department of tourist development a marketing division to be under the direction of the commissioner of tourist development. The commissioner may appoint a person to head the division, and such person shall perform all duties regarding the division as prescribed by the commissioner.

SECTION 2. Tennessee Code Annotated, Section 4-3-2204(a)(1)(B), is amended by deleting "director" and substituting "division head".

SECTION 3. Tennessee Code Annotated, Section 4-3-2204(b), is amended by deleting the subsection and substituting:

The division shall:

- (1) Promote new investment in the tourism industry;
- (2) Provide comprehensive services to existing tourism enterprises;
- (3) Promote Tennessee attractions in other states; and
- (4) Distribute Tennessee informational publications.

SECTION 4. Tennessee Code Annotated, Section 4-3-2209, is amended by deleting the section and substituting:

(a) The department of tourist development is responsible for administering and maintaining the state's welcome centers. The department of transportation shall assist

with maintenance of welcome center facilities as may be agreed upon by the department of tourist development and the department of transportation.

(b)

(1) There is created in the department of tourist development a welcome centers division to be under the direction of the commissioner of tourist development. The commissioner may appoint a person to head the division, and such person shall perform all duties regarding the division as prescribed by the commissioner.

(2) The head of the welcome centers division shall oversee the welcome centers in the state, with responsibilities that include:

(A) Promoting this state's unique heritage and attractions for guests, through mediums such as photographs, posters, maps, music, and books;

(B) Training staff on aspects of this state's history and area attractions;

(C) Staffing welcome centers in accordance with department guidelines;

(D) Maintaining welcome center facilities and grounds, including landscaping, to provide a positive experience for guests; and

(E) Performing housekeeping activities necessary for a safe, clean, and operable environment at such welcome center facilities.

(3) The commissioner of finance and administration shall transfer from highway user taxes allocated to the highway fund an amount sufficient to support the annual appropriation for implementation and administration of all welcome centers in this state.

SECTION 5. This act takes effect upon becoming law, the public welfare requiring it.